



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*kṣamā satyaṃ damaḥ śaucaṃ
dānam indriya-saṃyamaḥ |
ahiṃsā guru-śuśrūṣā
tīrthānusaraṇaṃ dayā ||*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Forgiveness, truthfulness, self-control, purity, charity, sense restraint, non-violence, serving the guru, visiting holy places, and compassion are the virtues that shine as divine qualities. This verse is like a constellation of inner strengths, a map guiding you toward spiritual growth. It's not a rigid checklist, but rather a bouquet of blossoms, each contributing its unique fragrance to the garden of your soul.

Consider forgiveness. How often do you cling to resentment, poisoning your own well-being? Forgiveness isn't condoning harm, but liberating yourself from its grip. Truthfulness, too, is more than just avoiding lies. It's aligning your thoughts, words, and actions with your deepest values, living with integrity. Self-control and purity speak to mastering your impulses and cultivating inner cleanliness, letting go of what no longer serves you.

Charity isn't just about money; it's about giving your time, your skills, your empathy to those in need, recognizing the divine spark within everyone. Sense restraint helps you navigate the sensory world without getting lost in its illusions, finding balance. Non-violence extends beyond physical harm to include your thoughts and words, fostering peace within and around you. Serving the guru, or spiritual teacher, is about seeking guidance from those who have walked the path before you, learning from their wisdom. Visiting holy places can be interpreted as seeking out spaces, both internal and external, that inspire awe and connection to something larger than yourself. And compassion, the heart of it all, is recognizing the shared humanity that binds us together, feeling the suffering of others as your own.

In modern life, these qualities are more vital than ever. They are the antidotes to the cynicism, division, and materialism that often dominate our world. By cultivating these virtues, you can create a life of meaning, purpose, and joy, not just for yourself, but for all those whose lives you touch.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

In what one area of your life could you more actively cultivate one of these virtues to experience greater peace and connection?